

Ubuntu

For beginners, Ubuntu is now popularly synonymous with GNU/Linux. It is user-friendly, stable and has regular update schedule.

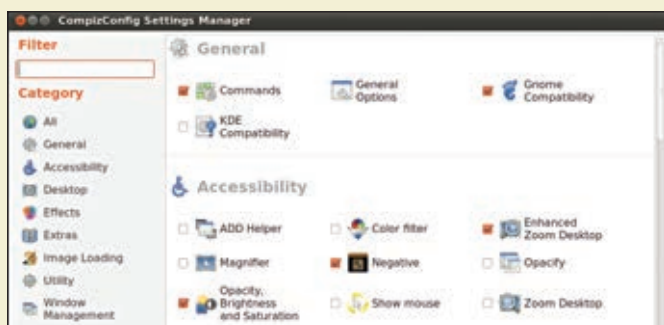
Visual effects

Although Ubuntu supports 3D effects by default (if your hardware supports it), they lack a way to configure significantly. To fix this simply install 'Compizconfig-settings-manager' either graphically from Synaptics or from Terminal by typing `$sudo apt-get install compizconfig-settings-manager`.

After installing you will find it in System > Preference,



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Tweaks, Settings, Plugins and more

open it and customise your visual effects as you like them.

Super Clipboard

If you ever wanted to copy multiple items to your clipboard, you can use a small (650 kb) utility called Glipper. Once installed, you can add it as an applet in any of your panels (named as Clipboard Manager), and now whenever you copy anything, your previous copied item is stored in a stack. You can select it by clicking the applet icon, and paste it in the regular way.

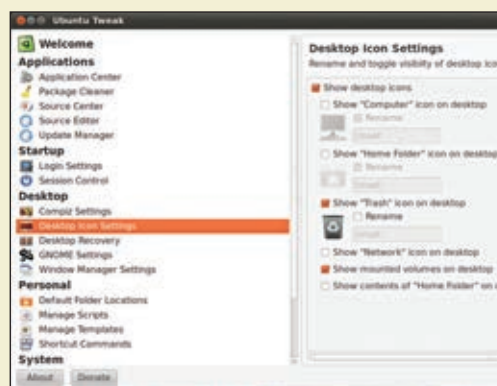
Ubuntu One

If you work on multiple computers, then Ubuntu One can aid your productivity a lot. Ubuntu One is file synchronisation service already built into Ubuntu (think Dropbox). Go to System >

Preference > Ubuntu One. Create an account from there or Sign-in with an existing one. You can configure which folders to sync, you can also purchase/download music and software from your Ubuntu One account. One note, if you are accessing the internet via a proxy server, this might not work for you, even if you configured the proxy in the global settings.

Ubuntu Tweak

This is a remarkable utility that lets you customise with ease. Download a DEB package from <http://ubuntu-tweak.com/> and double-click on it to install. Once installed, you can find it in Applications > System Tools.



Easy Graphical way of customising obscure settings

the description), so a sample search can be `sudo apt-cache search webserver`.

`$ sudo apt-cache show <package_name>` will show basic information about the package. (`apt-cache showpkg` will give detailed info).

`$ sudo apt-get remove <package_name>` will uninstall a package, and `$ sudo apt-get purge <package_name>` will completely remove saved setting files and downloaded installer from your hard drive.

Software Center

Synaptics is a great way to install software, but when you search for 'Text Editor' it will return a crowded list of files including terms as vague as libXYZ-dev and so on. If you get confused or irritated with that, use 'Ubuntu Software Center' under the Applications Menu. Here you can search for Full Applications only, and your search results won't be polluted with gibberish.

Faster PhotoViewer

If you think the default image viewer (Eye of Gnome or Gthumb) is a little too slow in displaying those high resolution images from your new digital camera. Give "Shotwell PhotoViewer" a try. It can use multiple cores of your CPU to pre-cache the image and the speed difference is very noticeable. The following steps should get you set for Ubuntu (or any

Debian-based distro)

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository ppa:yorba/ppa
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get install shotwell
```

Enable Root

Ubuntu disables the root account by default, and instead provides certain user account